

AFTER

KEY

- EEC members, January 1981
- Joined January 1986
- Admitted October 1990
- Joined January 1995
- Joined May 2004
- Joined January 2007
- Other countries applying for membership



- Germany**
- Joined April 18, 1951
 - Key industry Car manufacture



- Sweden**
- Joined January 1, 1995
 - Key industry Forestry

EU governments can be torn between the needs of the union and national interests.

MIGRATION AND RACE RELATIONS

EU membership allows free cross-border movement for workers between most member states. This has led to a large influx of migrant workers from poorer EU states into richer ones, **creating racial tensions** and demands for restrictions from **right-wing political elements** in Britain, France, Germany, and other member nations.

FINANCIAL UNION

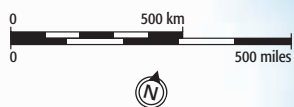
Although many countries joined **the euro** (the single currency) in 2002, some EU states have chosen to maintain their own currencies as they fear the **loss of national sovereign rights**.



EUROS



- Great Britain**
- Joined January 1, 1973
 - Key industry Finance



- Hungary**
- Joined May 1, 2004 (festivities above)
 - Key industry Transport equipment



Countries of the EU

The European Union has continued to expand since its origins in 1945. This map shows states that have joined since 1981. Supported by the umbrella of economic unity, newer member states with developing economies hope to emulate the economic growth of the established nations. European industry is successful in areas from agriculture and tourism to finance and fashion.

- Portugal**
- Joined January 1, 1986
 - Key industry Cork



- Spain**
- Joined January 1, 1986
 - Key industry Tourism



- France**
- Joined April 18, 1951
 - Key industry Agriculture



- Italy**
- Joined April 18, 1951
 - Key industry Fashion

